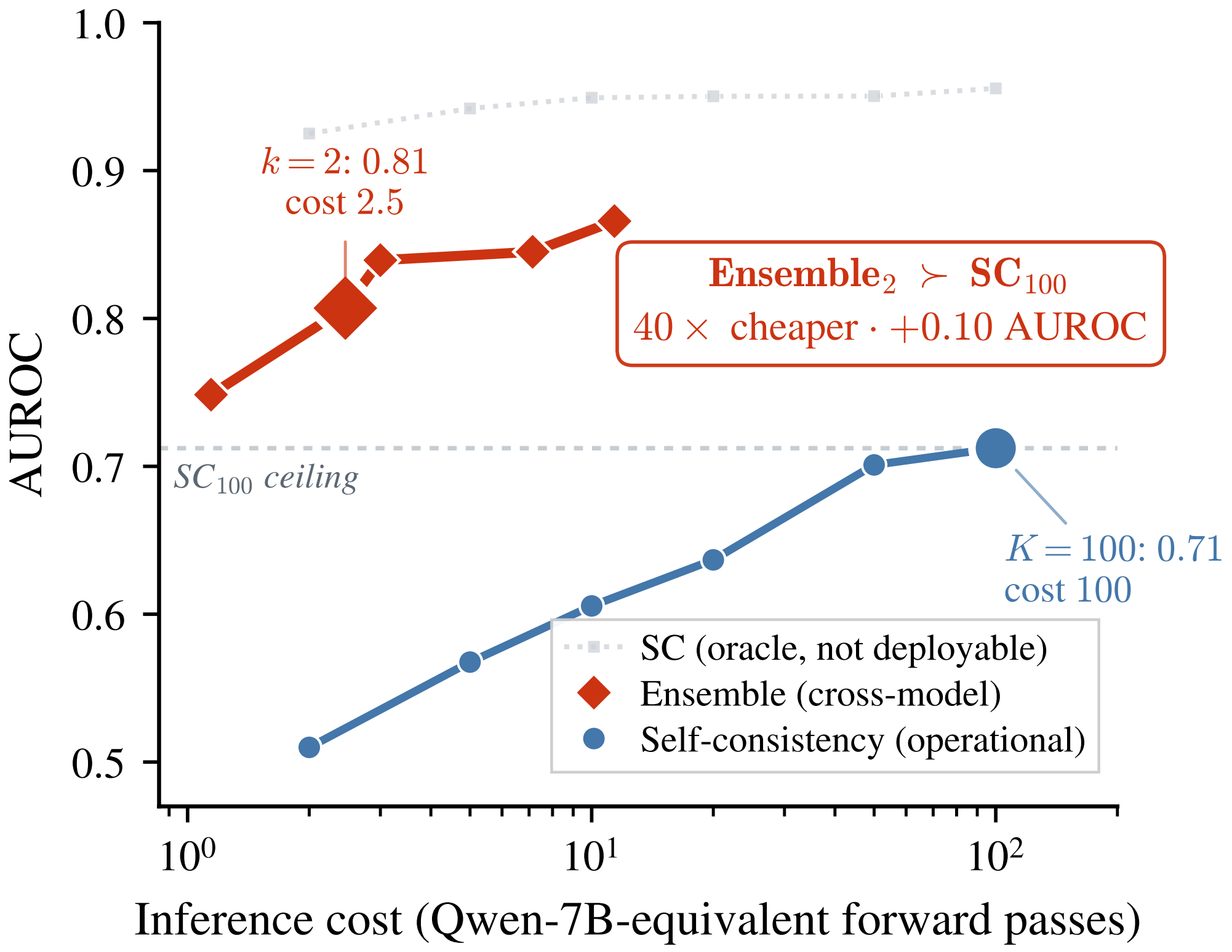
1.0
0.9
0.8
0.7
0.6
0.5
AUROC
$k = 2$: 0.81
cost 2.5
$\mathbf{Ensemble}_2 \succ \mathbf{SC}_{100}$
$40\times$ cheaper · +0.10 AUROC
SC_{100} ceiling
$K = 100$: 0.71
cost 100
SC (oracle, not deployable)
Ensemble (cross-model)
Self-consistency (operational)
10^0
10^1
10^2
Inference cost (Qwen-7B-equivalent forward passes)